

Lesson 101:

5-3 Fit and 4-4 Fit

1 TWO WAYS TO PLAY WITH TRUMPS



CONTROL OF THE HAND

Draw trumps, then cash the long suits.



TOTAL RUFFING

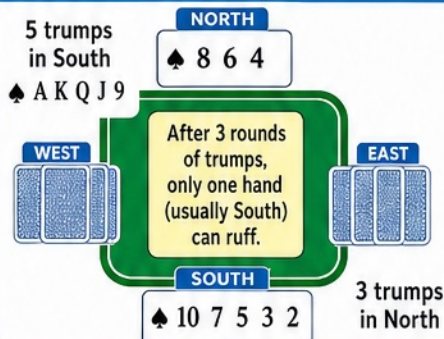
Ruff from both hands.

2 BASE HAND

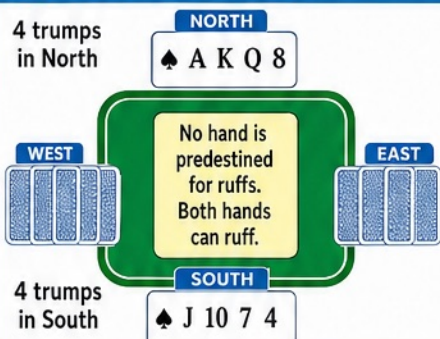
The one that draws the opponents' trumps (usually the longest in trumps).



3 5-3 FIT: THE MOST DELICATE



4 4-4 FIT: THE MOST POWERFUL



5 DEFENSE AGAINST SHORTENING



Refuse to ruff from the long hand!

Keep your long trumps for later.

6 5-3 FIT VS 4-4 FIT: COMPARATIVE CHART

FEATURE	5-3 FIT	4-4 FIT
TRUMP DISTRIBUTION	5-3 (uneven) ♠ ♠ ♠ ♠ ♠ ♠ ♠	4-4 (even) ♠ ♠ ♠ ♠ ♠ ♠ ♠ ♠
RUFFING POTENTIAL	Limited Only one hand can ruff early.	High Both hands can ruff. ↑
POWER	Less powerful Dependent on trump control.	More powerful Greater flexibility and strength. ↑
RISK	Higher Danger of being short in ruffs. ↑	Lower Safer and more balanced. ↓
BEST PLAN	Usually control: Draw trumps, then cash winners. 🎯	Usually total ruffing: Ruff from both hands. ✂️

7 EXAMPLE: HOW THE 4-4 FIT PRODUCES MORE TRICKS

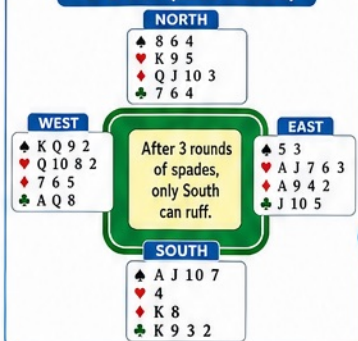
CONTRACT: 4♠
TRUMP: SPADES

♠ Spades
♥ Hearts
♦ Diamonds
♣ Clubs

TRICKS MADE
= 9 TRICKS

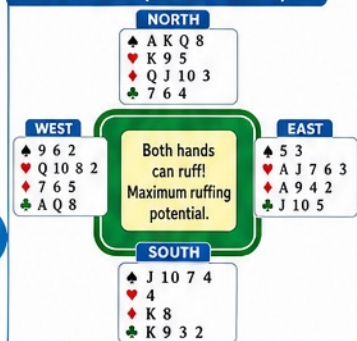
2 spade ruffs
+ 7 other tricks

5-3 FIT (LESS TRICKS)



VS

4-4 FIT (MORE TRICKS)



TRICKS MADE
= 11 TRICKS

4 spade ruffs
+ 7 other tricks



Even distribution (4-4 fit) gives you more options and more tricks.
Learn when to control the trumps and when to ruff everything!

Maestro Franci